PRODUCT STRATEGY & OPERATIONS LEADER

Ada Johnson

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Product Strategy & Operations leader with 20 years of experience at Airbnb, Google, Target, and Best Buy. A multiplier: I find the signal in customer, frontline, and operational data, connect it to the right people, and turn individual expertise into collective capability, through feedback loops and operating models that help organizations learn faster and scale responsibly.

CAREER ARC

Customer-Centric Operator → Product & Growth Strategist → Scalable Systems Builder → AI-Enabled Multiplier

CORE CAPABILITIES

Product Strategy & Operations | AI-Enabled Systems | AI Workflow Design | Feedback Systems | Operating Models | Voice of Customer | Go-to-Market Strategy | Strategic Partnerships

EXPERIENCE

AIRBNB · 2026 – Present

Manager, Project Implementation | Product Strategy & Operations, Fraud & Safety Delivery

Lead a team of 6 within Airbnb's newly formed Scaled Services organization, extending my Product Strategy & Operations focus to resolve ownership ambiguity across implementation, policy, and operations teams, and build how we measure whether an implementation actually succeeds, not just whether it ships on schedule.

AIRBNB · 2023 – 2026

Manager, Product Operations | Global Fraud & Safety Operations

Led Product Strategy & Operations for Airbnb's global Fraud & Safety operations. Built and led a team of 4 connecting frontline signals to Product and Engineering across 70+ enforcement workflows (identity, safety, financial fraud, account integrity).

- Created Fraud & Safety's AI-enabled frontline feedback loop: turned 1,360+ agent reports into 1,102 problems in 46 prioritized clusters, routed 94% to an owning team, and shipped 20 fixes in 3.5 months (median 31 days for issues that had waited a median of 8.5 months)
- Identified named ownership as what decided which fixes shipped: 46% of items with a named owner launched, versus 2% without one
- Fixes surfaced through the loop helped recover about 2,000 agent hours a month in the largest queue (75% of volume, handle time down 36%) and cut weekly escalations 57% in another
- Changed how Fraud & Safety measures operational health: designed the prototype Analytics rebuilt as the Queue Health Monitor (QHM), now the official source of truth for weekly and monthly business reviews across all 5 domains; credited by name at launch, it replaced a manual scorecard
- Developed my team to own business reviews by building AI workflows for root-cause analysis and prep that freed about 20 hours a week

GOOGLE · 2021 – 2023

Strategy & Product Operations Principal | Google Technology & Engineering

Led strategy and transformation initiatives for Google's global frontline technology support organization, redesigning operating models to improve scalability, efficiency, and workforce sustainability.

- Co-led the strategy and business case that moved Google's 800+ person frontline IT support org across 7 locations from a contractor to a full-time model, aligning Engineering, Finance, HR, and Legal; 249 of 252 offers accepted (98.8%)
- Designed the prioritization frameworks and executive decision mechanisms leadership used to align complex stakeholder groups faster

GOOGLE · 2019 – 2021

Strategy & Product Operations Lead | Google One Partnerships

Led global partner strategy and operations for Google One, scaling a consumer subscription product through telecommunications, OEM, and retail partnerships.

- Led Google One's partner expansion from 2 to 40+ global partners, supporting 89M+ addressable users and contributing to 95% subscription growth
- Built the operating model for global expansion: launch frameworks, partner playbooks, and operating rhythms that scaled across markets
- Influenced product roadmap and growth strategy by turning partner, performance, and customer data into recommendations

FOUNDATIONAL EXPERIENCE

GOOGLE · 2016 – 2019

Product Planning Lead, Google Store · General Manager, West Hollywood Pop-Up · Global Program Manager, Google Merchandise Store

- Grew Merchandise Store revenue 43% over two years on a $14M global program across 48 countries; introduced Google hardware, adding $9M incremental revenue and 81K+ device sales
- Directed 40+ staff to launch Google's first LA pop-up store, beating sales and conversion targets by 5%; created 10+ hardware business plans connecting customer insight to financial opportunity

TARGET CORPORATION · 2012 – 2015

Senior Buyer, Infant & Toddler Furniture · Senior Product Manager, Global Sourcing

- Turned a declining $75M category to +20% year over year; delivered $4M in annual cost savings on a $90M owned-brand sourcing portfolio

BEST BUY CORPORATION · 2006 – 2012

Merchant & Category Strategy | Various Categories

- Co-developed a $5M Batman: Arkham City launch campaign that generated $10M in first-week revenue

LEADERSHIP

- Co-Founder & Lead Organizer, Black in Product Operations @ Google
- Former Alumni Board President & Guest Lecturer, UMN College of Design
- NCAA Division I Track & Field, University of Minnesota (Alumna)

EDUCATION

- MBA, Business Entrepreneurship, Bethel University, Saint Paul, Minnesota
- BS, Retail Merchandising & Business Management, University of Minnesota, Twin Cities